

Budget Tracker — Product Proposal v3

17 tabs. AI-powered. One-time fee. Privacy-first. The most thorough budget spreadsheet on Etsy — engineered to compete with \$109/year apps.

Status: Approved — 2026-05-10 (v3 final) | **Tabs:** 17 | **Pricing:** \$12 / \$22 / \$34

 **Why a Spreadsheet, Not an App?** Your bank credentials never leave your bank. No data shared. No subscription. No vendor lock-in. Methodology-agnostic (50/30/20, Zero-Based, Envelope, Pay-Yourself-First — all in one). Google Sheets mobile IS your app.

 **Privacy-first:** No Plaid handshake. No aggregator. No data ever leaves your machine.

Core Budgeting Methods

- **50/30/20 Rule** — Needs / Wants / Savings split auto-calculated
- **Zero-Based Budgeting** — every dollar assigned before spending
- **Envelope Budgeting** — virtual envelopes with real-time deductions
- **Pay Yourself First** — savings moved to top of budget

Sheet Tabs (17 tabs)

Tab	Description
 Setup Wizard	Method, currency, tax region (US/UK/CA/AU), household toggle
 Dashboard	Snapshot + Health Score 0–100 + Age of Money + Top 3 vendors
 Income Tracker	All streams. Age of Money. Irregular income buffer. Per-paycheck allocation
Income Categories	Customizable: Primary Job, Freelance, Rental, Dividends, Side Hustle
 Expense Tracker	+ Split transactions, Tags, Tax-deductible flag, Refund-expected flag
Expense Categories	Pre-built groups (Housing, Food, Transport, etc.) — all editable
 Recurring Templates	One-time setup of monthly bills/subs → auto-populates Expense Tracker
 Refund Tracker	Mark transactions "expecting refund". Aged receivables list
Credit Card Manager	Up to 6 cards: balance, APR, minimum, due date, accruing interest
Emergency Fund	3-month / 6-month targets. Months of coverage. Visual progress
Savings Goals	Up to 10 goals: target, deadline, monthly needed
 Bill Calendar	+ .ics export to Google/Apple/Outlook

ENH Cash Flow Forecast	30/60/90-day + Emergency-fund-first sequencing logic
NEW Mileage Tracker	Business mileage: date, purpose, odometer, IRS rate × miles = deduction
ENH Annual Summary	+ YoY comparison + Top vendors + Date-range filter + Tax Prep + FIRE Timeline
Household Mode	Two-income, shared expense splitting, settlement, joint goals
NEW Financial Health Score	0–100 composite (savings 25% + EF 25% + DTI 20% + utilization 15% + on-time 15%)
AI AI Money Advisor	7 AI prompts

Features Borrowed from Professional Competitors

Feature	Source	What It Does
Zero-Based Budgeting Engine	YNAB	Every dollar assigned before month starts
Age of Money	YNAB	"You're spending money X days old" — irregular income safety
Cash Flow Forecasting	PocketSmith	Forward-looking projection, danger-month alerts
Rollover Spending	Copilot	Unused budget rolls into next month
Subscription Audit	Copilot	All subs with monthly cost, true annual total
Refund Tracker	Simplifi	Mark expecting refund, aged receivables
Top Vendor Analytics	Monarch	"\$4,200 at Amazon this year"
Calendar .ics export	Undebt.it	Sync bill calendar to Google/Apple/Outlook
Financial Health Score	SenticMoney	0–100 composite metric
Mileage Tracker	Quicken/Simplifi	IRS-rate business deduction calculator

What This Sheet Doesn't Do (And Why That's a Feature)

Cannot do	Spun positive
No bank sync	Your credentials never leave your bank
No ML categorization	Your data trains nobody else's model
No auto-detection	Recurring Templates tab — set once, run forever
No native mobile app	Google Sheets mobile IS your app
No subscription	Pay once, own forever

Disclosed dated claims: YNAB \$109/yr, Monarch \$99.99/yr, Copilot \$13/mo verified Jan 2026 — re-verify before launch. US savings rate 3.9% — BEA cited in Setup tab. "AI version not on Etsy" — May 2026 verification. "Top sellers \$10k–\$20k/mo" is reviewer estimate, not independently confirmed.

Pricing & Tiers

ESSENTIALS

Simple. Works out of the box.

- Setup Wizard (method + currency + region)
- Dashboard with key indicators
- Income tracker + categories
- Expense tracker + categories (with split + tags)
- Credit card manager (up to 3 cards)
- Emergency fund tab
- Bill calendar (60-day)
- 50/30/20 scorecard
- Annual summary + YoY view
- Google Sheets + Excel

\$12

PRO

\$22

Dark mode. Power-user features.

- Everything in Essentials
- Dark mode
- Zero-based budgeting engine
- Paycheck allocation + Age of Money
- Recurring Templates tab
- Refund Tracker
- Mileage Tracker (self-employed)
- Tax-deductible flag + Tax Prep Summary
- Cash flow forecast (90-day, EF-first logic)
- Bill calendar .ics export
- Subscription audit, top vendor analytics
- Up to 6 credit cards
- Household mode (2 incomes)
- Custom date-range filter
- FIRE Timeline mini-calc
- Multi-currency support

AI EDITION

\$34

Your money, with a brain.

- Everything in Pro
- Financial Health Score 0–100 (live)
- **AI Money Advisor Tab** with 7 prompts:
 - → **Smart Spending Advisor** — 3 ranked spending cuts with exact dollar amounts
 - → **Scenario Simulator** — model 12-month savings, debt payoff & NW impact
 - → **Spending Scripts** — AI-written negotiation + cancel-sub scripts
 - → **Cash Flow Intelligence** — flags danger months 60 days ahead
 - → **Annual Money Review** — year-end summary + next-year priorities
 - → **Category Advisor** — over-allocated vs. industry benchmarks
 - → **Health Score Coach** — explains your score + top 3 actions to raise it

Cross-Sells (NOT duplicated in this product)

- **Net Worth tab** — full version in Net Worth Tracker (Product 4); 3-line summary here
- **Debt Snowball/Avalanche** — full version in Debt Payoff Planner (Product 2); total debt only here
- **Sinking Funds** — full version in Sinking Funds Planner (Product 3); total as one line here
- **Detailed FIRE forecasting** — full personalised AI FIRE in Net Worth Tracker
- **Bundle anchor** — entry product into All-in-One Finance Bundle (\$97 Pro / \$149 AI)
- **Annual rollover** — December → January carries forward sinking funds, goals, templates

Strategic positioning: One-time \$12–\$34 vs. YNAB at \$109/year, Monarch \$99/year, Copilot \$156/year. We capture the audience that wants smart features without subscription lock-in — adding an AI layer no Etsy competitor offers.